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17 You want a slight undercut on the foot area so use the bowl gouge at first, then use the French curve scraper to refine the curve, don't go too deep as this will have an impact on the top side later when you dish the top for the bowl foot. Place a dovetail on the spigot with the skew

18 Due to this being square I would never recommend sanding while the lathe is running, the risk of injury is too high. Stop the lathe and hand sand this through all the grades, try to sand in the direction of the grain. This will not take as long as you might think

19 Place a thin piece of masking tape on the spigot to reduce the chance of the jaws marking the spigot. You can see the recess that I use to turn the bottom part. Start to dish this towards the centre

20 Start to thin the edges down to the finished thickness of 3mm, leave the centre part to reduce flexing the piece. Do this with light cuts only. Once down to the correct thickness, move on to the next part and continue until you reach the centre

21 Use the parting tool to cut a 2mm deep recess for the foot of the bowl to sit in. Dish the centre slightly to match the base of the bowl base, but do make sure it is flat towards the edge

22 As I said before, I would not sand a square edge item with the lathe rotating. I use this sanding aid, which is held in the chuck with a sanding arbor to sand items like these. I still go through all the grades of abrasives checking that all the marks have been removed. I will then add oil onto the surface and while it's still wet, sand with 600 grade in the direction of the grain and buff to a finish

23 The completed bowl and saucer should look something like this ●

HANDY HINTS

3. Be very aware of the square corners on the saucer when the lathe is turning
4. Sand by hand when you are turning an irregular shaped item. It would only take a fraction of a second to have an accident if you tried to sand an item with corners on while the lathe was turning
5. Sand with the grain direction to avoid leaving scratch marks behind
6. Stop the lathe frequently to check wall thickness on items that have thin walls
7. Choose a food-safe timber if you're intending to use the bowl as a drinking vessel
8. Take light cuts on thin wall items to avoid timber flexing

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